

continue improving,” Stoepe concluded.

Facebook releases open source tool to ease React developments

Facebook brought out React as its open source JavaScript library to let developers access its native user experience. But as developments using the library became tough for many individual developers and enterprises due to ‘an overwhelming explosion of tools’, the social networking giant has now



released the Create React App.

Having evolved from a hackathon project, Create React App provides an official way to create single-page React apps. The tool is designed to extend the presence of React without abandoning the company’s open source philosophy, which

became apparent three years back with the release of the JavaScript library in March 2013.

“Create React App is a new officially supported way to create single-page React applications. It offers a modern build set-up with no configuration,” Facebook’s Dan Abramov explained in a blog post.

Facebook has designed Create React App in such a way that it leverages both the Webpack asset-bundling tool and the Babel JavaScript compiler. Also, there is the ESLint code-linting tool to list out all the lint warnings right from the console.

The build settings on Create React App tool are pre-configured, and there is just a single dependency for developing multiple React apps. Moreover, Facebook has provided all the necessary instructions on GitHub to let developers easily build some of their interesting apps.

“This is an experiment, and only time will tell if it becomes a popular way of creating and building React apps, or fades into obscurity,” Abramov stated.

Although Facebook is looking forward to influencing some developers through its Create React App, Abramov’s statement hints at a cloudy future. The company still needs to make developers aware of the benefits of its JavaScript library. Also, basic features such as testing codes are yet to arrive on the open source tool.

That being said, Facebook’s Create React App would be a productive tool for all those developers who want to ease their development efforts on the framework that is already available on multiple platforms including Android, iOS and Windows 10. The new tool will also result in the development of many new Web apps in the future.

Google develops an open source API to ease password management on Android

Google has announced the development of a new open source API project that will simplify password management on Android devices. This new move emerges from a partnership between the search giant and password manager Dashlane.

Called Open Yolo (You only login once), the new open API is specifically

Ubuntu Touch starts supporting fingerprint scanners

Canonical has released Ubuntu Touch OTA-12 as its latest open source mobile platform. The new Ubuntu Touch version has native support for a fingerprint scanner to let users add an advanced security layer on top of their interface.

As biometric security solutions are the trend, Canonical addressed that demand and added the support for a fingerprint scanner.

Though the support is available intrinsically within the new Ubuntu Touch version, the Meizu Pro 5 Ubuntu Edition is the only device so far to offer the new experience.

Also, you are allowed to store any five of your fingerprints on the smartphone. This could be to restrict access to the device to just one user.

Apart from the support for fingerprint authentication, the new Ubuntu Touch version has convergence with an all-new libertine scope for converged devices, animated mouse cursors, MPRIIS support for playlists and an on-screen keyboard support for X apps. The operating system also lets you maximise windows both horizontally and vertically.

Canonical has bundled updates of its core apps with the latest Ubuntu Touch. There is the message forwarding option within the default messaging app. Additionally, there is the coloured emoji feature for the Ubuntu keyboard and wireless display support for Ubuntu tablets such as the Aquaris M10.

Ubuntu Touch OTA-12 has a new Oxide video player and an updated Web browser. The browser has got touch selection improvements and zoom support; it optimises tab view loading time and offers consistent page headers.

In addition to the new features, Ubuntu Touch OTA-12 comes with certain bug fixes. It fixes the screen dimming issue that was reported on some devices. Besides, there are WebRTC fixes for selecting cameras, connectivity fixes and some stability improvements.

You can check for the availability of the newest version of Ubuntu Touch on your smartphone or tablet. It comes as an over-the-air update for all the recent smartphone and tablet hardware.